

China Industrials

Industrial insights (Aug): Mixed picture

Equities

China
Industrial

Mixed demand signals; structural growth remains intact

We present key industrial data in our monthly China [Industrials Chartbook](#). The data revealed a mixed picture of activity. August domestic demand for excavators and heavy-duty trucks (HDT) was relatively weak, while domestic infrastructure investment and shipbuilding orders declined YoY in July. In contrast, orders for automation and semiconductor equipment remained strong. Industrial exports remained strong, rising 17% YoY in July. Our covered China industrial stocks outperformed the CSI 300 index by 4.9ppt in the past month. Battery equipment, TIC, solar equipment, automation and shipbuilding all gained more than 3%. By contrast, construction machinery and HDT stocks delivered lackluster performance (down 4%), with the exception of Sany International and Lonking. The three best-performing stocks were Neway CNC, SBT Ultrasonic and Yangzijiang Shipbuilding; the three worst-performing stocks were XCMG, Zhejiang Dingli and Guangxi Liugong. Against a weak domestic macroeconomic backdrop, we recommend leading companies with strong earnings visibility and exposure to structural growth, as well as attractive valuations, such as Sany International, Sino-truck A/H, JDI, CTI, Sany Heavy, CSSC, CRRC-H and OPT.

Excavators and HDT remain soft; July orders of shipbuilding wins weakened

Infrastructure FAI (ex. utilities) recorded a continued and accelerating decline, from -11.5% YoY in June to -12.3% YoY in July. Our dealer checks suggest August domestic excavator sales of c8,000 units (+4% YoY), with underlying demand remaining soft. Dealers attribute the recent slowdown to June order pull-forward, seasonal weakness and normalization of domestic-sales-to-export transactions. Pricing remains stable, while repayment conditions have yet to show meaningful improvement despite ongoing debt resolution measures. August remained a seasonally weak month for [HDT](#) demand, with domestic demand declining MoM from July due to sluggish LNG truck sales, while export demand stayed resilient. The shipbuilding newbuild price index is up 0.1% MoM in August. New order wins weakened in July, down 28% YoY and down 61% MoM.

Automation orders solid despite weak manufacturing investment

Factory automation: China's manufacturing investment turned negative in July, although our channel checks suggest automation orders maintained solid growth in August, primarily driven by AIDC-related capex and industrial upgrades in a mild traditional downstream. August updates reinforced a common investment theme across **solar/semi equipment** companies (eg, Maxwell and SC New Energy): semiconductor-related businesses are becoming increasingly important. As the PV equipment cycle remains subdued, investors are paying closer attention to opportunities in hybrid bonding, advanced packaging/TGV and semiconductor components, which we expect to drive the next leg of medium-term growth.

Emerging themes: WRC highlights and latest commercial space developments

Humanoid robots: The 2026 World Robot Conference (WRC) underscored the robotics industry's shift from a technical showcase to commercial deployment. Advances in embodied intelligence, core components and automated workflows are expanding applications across manufacturing, logistics, retail, healthcare and emergency response, while policy support and corporate participation are accelerating n and adoption. **Commercial space:** China's aerospace industry is entering an accelerated growth phase. In reusable launch vehicles, LandSpace's Zhuque-3 Y2 completed China's first land recovery of an orbital-class rocket first stage on 19 Aug, following the Long March 10B's achievement of the world's first offshore net-capture recovery. These milestones indicate China's reusable rocket technology has entered a faster validation stage, which we expect to reduce launch costs.

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Figure 1: Valuation summary – our preferred stocks in China's industrial sector

Name	RIC Code	Market Cap (US\$ bn)	Rating	PT (LC)	Price (LC)	PE (x)		P/BV (x)		ROE (%)		Name	RIC Code	Market Cap (US\$ bn)	Rating	PT (LC)	Price (LC)	PE (x)		P/BV (x)		ROE (%)	
						2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E							2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E
CSSC	600150.SS	37.8	Buy	52.00	33.80	13.1x	10.2x	1.6x	1.4x	12.8	14.8	Sungrow	300274.SZ	34.4	Buy	165.00	111.50	17.0x	14.4x	4.0x	3.2x	25.8	24.5
Sinotruk-A	000951.SZ	3.4	Buy	28.00	19.72	10.7x	9.6x	1.4x	1.3x	13.6	14.2	Sany Heavy	600031.SS	25.5	Buy	23.20	18.61	15.6x	12.6x	1.8x	1.7x	12.0	13.7
Sinotruk-H	3808.HK	13.4	Buy	51.00	38.14	11.0x	9.0x	1.8x	1.7x	17.7	19.4	CRRC-H	1766.HK	19.2	Buy	7.50	5.23	9.1x	8.1x	0.7x	0.7x	8.1	8.6
Putailai	603659.SS	7.8	Buy	43.00	24.42	14.7x	11.4x	2.2x	1.9x	16.2	18.0	CTI	300012.SZ	3.8	Buy	20.50	15.16	22.8x	20.0x	3.0x	2.6x	13.8	14.1
JD Industrials	7618.HK	4.5	Buy	22.80	13.90	23.0x	15.5x	2.6x	2.2x	11.9	15.2	Sany International	0631.HK	3.4	Buy	9.45	8.26	11.5x	9.1x	1.6x	1.5x	14.7	17.2
OPT	688686.SS	2.2	Buy	176.00	119.23	57.7x	39.2x	4.5x	4.2x	8.1	11.1												

Source: Thomson Reuters, UBS-S estimates. Note: Data as of 24 Aug 2026.

Figure 2: Summary of key industrial-related numbers (YoY)

		2025 YoY											2026 YoY							2025 vs
		Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	Jul	Aug	Sept	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	2024	
Manufacturing	Construction machinery																			
	Excavator sales (total)	1%	53%	18%	18%	25%	13%	25%	8%	14%	19%	50%	-11%	26%	30%	36%	35%	14%	17%	
	o/w: domestic	0%	99%	29%	16%	17%	15%	22%	2%	9%	11%	61%	-42%	23%	35%	39%	34%	4%	18%	
	o/w: export	2%	13%	3%	19%	32%	11%	29%	13%	19%	27%	40%	37%	32%	23%	34%	36%	21%	16%	
	Pangyuan index: proxy for rental rate	-7%	-19%	1%	-12%	-9%	-12%	-8%	-22%	0%	-1%	19%	12%	-11%	12%	2%	-5%	14%	-9%	
	Tower crane for fabricated building (ton meters)	-6%	-1%	-4%	-8%	-7%	0%	-8%	-4%	-3%	-1%	4%	7%	5%	3%	4%	3%	0%	-5%	
	Loader sales (total)	2%	34%	13%	19%	-84%	0%	30%	28%	32%	30%	48%	9%	22%	32%	27%	25%	31%	18%	
	o/w: domestic	-1%	63%	23%	35%	2%	0%	26%	33%	29%	18%	43%	-14%	17%	17%	23%	16%	27%	22%	
	o/w: export	4%	13%	1%	0%	13%	0%	35%	23%	35%	41%	53%	34%	31%	57%	76%	33%	35%	13%	
	Crane sales (total)	-21%	0%	-17%	-3%	10%	0%	22%	15%	17%	38%	29%	-12%	26%	10%	18%	19%	7%	1%	
	Heavy-duty truck																			
	HDT sales	-25%	36%	-4%	7%	46%	47%	83%	60%	65%	22%	46%	-10%	25%	33%	23%	19%	-1%	27%	
	o/w: construction HDT	-28%	28%	5%	22%	68%	52%	71%	39%	47%	19%	38%	-2%	22%	15%	16%	15%	-1%	28%	
	o/w: logistics HDT	-23%	45%	-11%	-6%	29%	42%	95%	83%	85%	25%	54%	-16%	27%	53%	31%	23%	-1%	26%	
	Automation																			
	Industrial robot production	NA	NA	22%	42%	40%	33%	41%	14%	31%	26%	NA	NA	49%	30%	46%	48%	55%	32%	
	Lithium battery installed capacity	20%	92%	62%	53%	35%	33%	39%	42%	39%	30%	8%	-24%	0%	15%	26%	31%	33%	40%	
	Solar cells production	NA	NA	42%	56%	44%	55%	11%	2%	8%	11%	NA	NA	-9%	-10%	-6%	10%	-1%	28%	
	Shipbuilding																			
	New order (in dwt)	-45%	-43%	-72%	-31%	31%	-49%	4%	2%	76%	100%	78%	171%	125%	48%	140%	13%	-28%	-19%	
	Delivery (in dwt)	-13%	-45%	21%	-7%	15%	7%	72%	14%	51%	15%	26%	26%	19%	7%	-2%	10%	15%	9%	
	Container																			
	Production	51%	NA	23%	-9%	-17%	-25%	-29%	-52%	-42%	-35%	-14%	-14%	-14%	-14%	-14%	-14%	-14%	-21%	
	Export volume	45%	-6%	30%	24%	0%	-45%	-30%	-18%	-12%	-12%	-19%	-17%	-34%	-20%	-33%	0%	2%	-16%	
Infrastructure	Infra FAI																			
	Infrastructure FAI (incl. utilities)	10%	10%	13%	10%	-1%	-3%	-4%	-8%	-9%	-10%	NA	11%	7%	-3%	-10%	-11%	-15%	1%	
	Infrastructure FAI (excl. utilities)	6%	6%	6%	6%	-5%	-6%	-5%	-9%	-10%	-12%	NA	11%	7%	-3%	-10%	-11%	-12%	-2%	
	o/w: Transport	3%	3%	5%	4%	-4%	-5%	-5%	-10%	-2%	-13%	NA	9%	22%	2%	-6%	-8%	2%	1%	
	o/w: Hydraulic, environmental and public facilities	9%	9%	11%	6%	-7%	-15%	-15%	-19%	-25%	-27%	NA	8%	0%	-8%	-14%	-13%	-27%	-8%	
	o/w: Utilities	25%	25%	26%	24%	13%	4%	-2%	-6%	-4%	-4%	NA	13%	7%	-5%	-12%	-9%	-25%	9%	
	Railway FAI (MoT)	7%	7%	5%	NA	6%	6%	7%	5%	7%	6%	NA	5%	5%	-1%	1%	1%	0%	6%	
	Highway FAI (MoT)	86%	86%	-10%	-9%	-3%	0%	1%	-6%	-5%	NA	NA	NA	NA	-16%	NA	-11%	NA	-6%	
	Power grid FAI (CES)	33%	33%	18%	107%	-1%	26%	-11%	-14%	-1%	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	
	Construction new contract																			
	CSEEC new contract	4%	6%	13%	20%	9%	-3%	1%	5%	2%	0%	2%	2%	-4%	2%	-11%	0%	NA	2%	
	Housing	-16%	11%	-1%	-13%	30%	8%	4%	11%	19%	-23%	16%	2%	2%	9%	-17%	7%	NA	1%	
	Infrastructure	74%	-5%	53%	-21%	-35%	-28%	-4%	-4%	-21%	35%	-23%	2%	-15%	-8%	3%	-12%	NA	4%	
	PowerChina new contract	2%	17%	-30%	16%	-13%	10%	8%	-39%	-26%	-36%	-15%	-33%	60%	-40%	-49%	-4%	-58%	5%	
	MCC new contract	-13%	-43%	-27%	-17%	-13%	-15%	34%	28%	25%	-22%	-16%	9%	-17%	-46%	-35%	-28%	-46%	-11%	

Source: Company data, National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC), Ministry of Transport (MoT), China Aviation Administration of China (CAAC), China Port Association, National Energy Administration (NEA), China Construction Machinery Association (CCMA), China Association of Automobile Manufacturers (CAAM). Note: Airline data are an aggregation of Air China, China Southern, China Eastern and Spring Airlines. Airport pax throughput is an aggregation of Baiyun, Shanghai, Xiamen, Shenzhen and Beijing Capital international airports. Airport freight throughput is an aggregation of Baiyun, Shanghai, Xiamen and Shenzhen. Aircraft movement is an aggregation of Baiyun, Shanghai and Xiamen. Taiwan's shipping revenue includes revenue from Evergreen, Yang Ming and Wanhai. CES = China's energy storage. Green means above historical average; red means below historical average

Figure 3: UBS-S coverage universe – industrial stocks

Ticker	EN	Lead	Rating	MarketCap (Rmb bn)	TP	LC	Upside	1wk	1mth	3mth	Last update
000300.SH	CS300						4,618.9	-2.20	-1.85	-7.28	
Construction machinery											
600031.SH	Sany Heavy Industry	Phyllis Wang	Buy	171.1	23.2	18.6	25%	-0.75	-4.95	-0.22	2026-03-31
601100.SH	Jiangsu Hengli Hydraulic	Phyllis Wang	Buy	140.9	128	105.8	21%	-1.10	-1.57	-4.81	2026-04-22
000425.SZ	XCMG Construction Machinery	Phyllis Wang	Buy	93.3	12.6	7.9	59%	-0.63	-10.69	-16.66	2026-04-30
000157.SZ	Zoomlion Heavy Industry Science & Tech A	Phyllis Wang		61.1	8.7	7.1	23%	2.02	-4.33	-2.88	2026-04-01
1157.HK	Zoomlion Heavy Industry Science & Tech H	Phyllis Wang		52.5	8.95	7.1	26%	3.71	-5.50	-1.25	2026-04-01
603338.SH	Zhejiang Dingli Machinery	Yuhua Li		27.7	60	54.7	10%	-1.69	-4.11	1.10	2026-04-28
0631.HK	Sany Heavy Equipment International	Yuhua Li	Buy	22.9	9.45	8.1	17%	10.74	9.10	-6.37	2026-07-16
000528.SZ	Guangxi Liugong Machinery	Yuhua Li	Buy	16.3	13.6	8.1	69%	-0.98	-5.18	-9.62	2026-04-28
3339.HK	Lonking	Yuhua Li		11.8	3.2	3.2	-1%	9.49	4.19	15.20	2025-11-17
Sector average								2.31	-2.56	-2.83	
Automation											
300124.SZ	Shenzhen Inovance Technology	Phyllis Wang	Buy	157.8	86	58.3	48%	-4.74	-1.77	-25.55	2026-04-29
002050.SZ	Zhejiang Sanhua Intelligent Controls	Nora Min	Buy	150.3	62	35.7	74%	-6.76	1.88	-33.31	2026-07-27
688777.SH	Zhejiang Supcon Technology	Phyllis Wang		69.5	74.8	88.3	-15%	-7.23	7.83	0.84	2026-03-16
688017.SH	Leader Harmonious Drive Systems	Phyllis Wang		49.8	52.9	295.2	82%	-15.65	-0.05	-15.39	2024-11-20
002747.SZ	Estun Automation	Phyllis Wang		29.8	22.4	30.8	27%	-11.31	2.60	7.72	2026-04-16
002444.SZ	Hangzhou Great Star Industrial	Phyllis Wang	Buy	34.2	43	28.6	50%	-3.74	2.29	-13.17	2026-04-29
7618.HK	JD Industrials	Phyllis Wang	Buy	29.9	22.8	13.3	72%	-1.63	-0.52	-11.06	2026-03-09
301029.SZ	Dongguan Yiheda Automation	Phyllis Wang		15.7	28.8	24.7	17%	-7.39	4.22	-18.54	2025-08-18
002158.SZ	Shanghai Hanbell Precise Machinery	Phyllis Wang	Buy	13.9	31.1	26.0	20%	-7.78	4.42	-21.32	2026-04-27
688686.SH	OPT Machine Vision	Phyllis Wang	Buy	14.6	176	119.2	48%	2.67	11.60	-21.92	2026-08-21
300820.SZ	Sichuan Injet Electric Co., Ltd.	Phyllis Wang	Buy	11.7	60	52.7	14%	-4.93	4.55	-21.40	2026-04-30
601882.SH	Ningbo Haitian Precision Machinery	Phyllis Wang	Buy	10.3	24.3	19.8	23%	-2.71	10.09	-15.71	2026-03-24
688697.SH	Neway CNC Equipment	Phyllis Wang	Buy	9.4	13.7	14.7	-7%	0.96	28.52	-13.10	2026-04-28
603915.SH	Jiangsu Guomao Reducer	Phyllis Wang	Buy	8.5	20.6	12.9	59%	-2.41	7.39	-28.16	2026-01-13
Sector average								-5.19	5.93	-16.43	
Rolling Stock											
601766.SH	CRRC Corp - A	Yuhua Li	Buy	174.5	9.9	6.1	63%	3.40	4.44	7.70	2026-08-20
1766.HK	CRRC Corp - H	Yuhua Li	Buy	128.8	7.5	5.2	43%	6.07	6.94	3.10	2025-08-25
3898.HK	Zhuzhou CRRC	Yuhua Li	Buy	39.7	50.4	33.6	50%	-3.23	0.84	-19.13	2026-08-20
Sector average								2.08	4.07	-2.78	
Testing											
300012.SZ	Centre Testing International	Phyllis Wang	Buy	25.5	20.5	15.2	35%	8.44	13.22	2.29	2026-08-19
300416.SZ	Suzhou Sushi Testing	Phyllis Wang	Buy	7.3	19.7	14.3	37%	-4.40	5.36	-25.11	2026-03-27
603018.SH	China Design Group	Grace Wang		4.3	6.25	5.2	20%	-1.89	4.42	-14.00	2026-04-21
Sector average								0.72	7.67	-12.27	
Battery equipment											
300450.SZ	Wuxi Lead Intelligent Equipment	Kunlun Li		56.7	36	33.8	6%	-2.70	5.68	-31.67	2026-05-07
688392.SH	SBT Ultrasonic Technology	Kunlun Li	Buy	22.2	160	193.1	-17%	8.79	26.20	16.81	2026-04-10
300457.SZ	Shenzhen Yinghe Technology	Kunlun Li		13.8	18.4	21.3	-13%	4.68	17.34	-24.58	2026-04-02
Sector average								3.59	16.41	-13.14	
PV equipment											
300316.SZ	Zhejiang Jingsheng M&E	Kunlun Li		56.3	44.3	43.0	3%	-1.15	10.20	-23.78	2026-04-15
300751.SZ	Suzhou Maxwell	Kunlun Li		56.4	244.1	201.7	21%	13.08	11.26	-32.23	2026-04-30
300724.SZ	Shenzhen SC New Energy	Kunlun Li		19.6	94.3	56.3	68%	-3.94	0.95	-35.75	2026-04-27
Sector average								2.66	7.47	-30.59	
Diversified Industrials											
002851.SZ	Shenzhen Megmeet Electrical	Kunlun Li		69.7	124.8	119.8	4%	-8.80	-1.99	-9.44	2026-04-29
600885.SH	Hongfa Technology	Kunlun Li	Buy	52.7	47.6	34.1	40%	-5.91	-0.26	-1.50	2026-07-30
Sector average								-7.35	-1.13	-5.47	
Defence											
688297.SH	Avic (Chengdu) Uas	Xin Chen		25.8	50.32	38.3	31%	-6.08	-3.87	-16.49	2025-09-09
300699.SZ	Weihai Guangwei Composites	Kunlun Li		19.9	36	24.0	50%	-6.07	-2.12	-29.20	2026-04-24
2357.HK	AviChina Industry & Technology	Xin Chen	Buy	19.8	5	3.0	69%	-0.67	0.68	-7.21	2025-09-05
Sector average								-4.27	-1.77	-17.63	
Shipbuilding											
000039.SZ	China International Marine Containers A	Robin Xu	Buy	49.9	14.2	9.3	54%	5.11	16.65	-6.75	2026-03-28
600150.SH	China CSSC Holdings	Kunlun Li	Buy	254.4	52	33.8	54%	1.14	2.24	-9.81	2026-05-07
YAZG.SI	Yangzijiang Shipbuilding	Kunlun Li	Buy	99.5	5.4	4.8	13%	3.03	19.00	26.93	2026-08-10
Sector average								3.09	12.63	3.46	
HDT											
3808.HK	Sinotruk (Hong Kong)	Wei Shen	Buy	90.3	51	39.1	30%	0.31	-5.46	6.25	2026-04-01
000951.SZ	Sinotruk Jinan Truck	Wei Shen	Buy	23.2	28	19.7	42%	-5.42	-10.77	-4.64	2026-01-27
000338.SZ	Weichai Power - A	Wei Shen		235.2	27.1	27.0	0%	-8.97	-1.11	-22.19	2026-04-09
2338.HK	Weichai Power	Wei Shen		232.5	32.1	33.4	-4%	-4.57	-0.12	-17.66	2026-04-09
Sector average								-4.66	-4.37	-9.56	
All average								-1.31	3.82	-11.14	

Source: Wind, UBS-S estimates. Note: Data as of 24 Aug 2026.

Industry channel/expert checks

Domestic excavator demand remained soft despite positive sales growth; August sales likely to increase c4% YoY

Our channel checks suggest August domestic excavator sales are likely to reach around 8,000 units, implying low-single-digit growth of ~4% YoY, broadly in line with July. Dealers believe the weaker July reading was primarily driven by order pull-forward into June around the interim reporting season, alongside normal seasonal weakness and a relatively high comparison base. Moreover, as leading OEMs increasingly tighten control of domestic-sales-to-export transactions, part of the demand previously recorded as domestic sales is being reclassified under export sales.

End-market demand remains subdued across infrastructure, property and other construction-related sectors, while several OEMs are undergoing organizational and channel restructuring, which has encouraged a more cautious sales approach and may have created an additional short-term disruption. Industry pricing remains largely stable, with no meaningful price increases successfully implemented so far. Meanwhile, repayment conditions have had little improvement despite ongoing local government debt resolution measures, suggesting that underlying contractor cash flow and project activity remain relatively weak.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Investment downsizing at the macroeconomic level remains a key risk for China's industrial sector. If China's economy remains weak, demand for industrial goods or import/export volume could shrink, resulting in slow growth. If preferential policies, such as tax incentives for high-tech companies, are cancelled, it could affect earnings. Intense competition with domestic or foreign enterprises could cause market share losses.

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
CRRC Corp - H ¹⁸	1766.HK	Buy	HK\$5.24	24 Aug 2026
Centre Testing International	300012.SZ	Buy	Rmb15.16	24 Aug 2026
China CSSC Holdings	600150.SS	Buy	Rmb33.80	24 Aug 2026
JD Industrials ^{2,4,6,28}	7618.HK	Buy	HK\$13.94	24 Aug 2026
OPT Machine Vision	688686.SS	Buy	Rmb119.23	24 Aug 2026
Sany Heavy Equipment International ²⁸	0631.HK	Buy	HK\$8.23	24 Aug 2026
Sany Heavy Industry ^{28,7}	600031.SS	Buy	Rmb18.61	24 Aug 2026
Shanghai Putailai New Energy Technology	603659.SS	Buy	Rmb24.42	24 Aug 2026
Sinotruk (Hong Kong)	3808.HK	Buy	HK\$38.14	24 Aug 2026
Sinotruk Jinan Truck	000951.SZ	Buy	Rmb19.72	24 Aug 2026
Sungrow Power Supply	300274.SZ	Buy	Rmb111.50	24 Aug 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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